Name: _____ English Period: _____
Date: _____

"Rikki Tikki Tavi"

In Class Discussion Questions

Directions: Answer the following questions in COMPLETE SENTENCES.

1. What is the setting of the story?
   Segowlee cantonment, India, the garden, the home of the English family.

2. Who is/are the protagonist(s)?
   Rikki-tikki-tavi.

3. Who is/are the antagonist(s)?
   Nag and Nagaina.

4. Why is Rikki unafraid of fighting the cobras?
   He instinctively knows how to fight them.

5. What is anthropomorphism?
   Attribution of human characteristics to non-humans.

6. Name another major character.
   None

7. Name a minor character.
   Teddy, Darzee, Darzee's wife, Karait, mother, father, boy

8. What is the central conflict?
   The cobras want to take over the garden and rid it of humans and animals. Garden animals vs. the Cobras

9. Identify an additional conflict found in the story.
   Rikki's burrow floods and he is washed out of his home; Rikki vs. Karait; Rikki's struggle to gain confidence; the cobras' eggs are ready to hatch; cobras eat one of Darzee's eggs; cobras plot to kill the family

10. What is the mood of the story? Why? How does the author use tone to create the mood?

    The author takes a frightening tone to create suspenseful mood throughout most of the story. He uses a happy tone at the end of the story to create a joyful mood.

11. Provide an example of foreshadowing in the story.

    Teddy's father says "Teddy's safer with that little beast than if he had a bloodhound to watch him. If a snake came into the nursery now—" This foreshadows the conflict with the cobras.

12. Are there possible symbols in the story? If so, what are they and what do you think they represent?

    - Rikki = courage/loyalty
    - Rikki's red eyes = anger
    - Nag/Nagaina = evil/death

13. From what point of view is the story told? Cite at least two examples from the text to support your answer.

    3rd person omniscient.

14. Using the plot mountain chart, plot out the events in the story.

15. Choose a character from the story. Identify a human personality trait for this character and cite at least two examples from the text to support your answer.

    Rikki: loyal because he protects the family or courageous because he fights the cobras.

16. Is the protagonist a static or dynamic character? Cite evidence to support your answer.

    Dynamic character. He gains confidence, is courageous, and wiser.

17. Identify at least one theme found within the story "Rikki Tikki Tavi."

    Triumph of good over evil; Loyalty, hard work, and courage prevail; strongest survive, it's okay to fight for survival.

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